

LISTENING

#23

1 – Listen to a conversation between a manager and an employee about a work report. Pay attention to what problems the employee faces, how the manager reacts, and what solutions they agree on.

A Solution

1 - What does Thiago say about the status of the report when Shaun asks?

2 - Why hasn't Thiago finished the assignment yet?

- a) He forgot the deadline
- b) Accounts didn't send him the figures
- c) He lost his notes

3 - When does Shaun need the report?

4 - What does Shaun offer to do to help Thiago?

- a) Talk to Accounts and find someone to share his workload
- b) Write the report himself
- c) Cancel the meeting with the directors

5 - How does Thiago react when Shaun suggests Jasmine's help?

6 - How much extra time does Shaun give Thiago?

7 - Why is Shaun still not satisfied after giving Thiago more time?

- a) The Accounts team hasn't answered
- b) Jasmine can't help
- c) He still has the directors' meeting tomorrow

8 - What alternative solution does Thiago propose to deal with the time pressure?

- a) Ask Shaun to postpone the directors' meeting
- b) Start the report from scratch
- c) Write an executive summary of the main points

9 - Who does Shaun have a meeting with tomorrow afternoon?

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

The Pressure of Presentations

It was already 7 p.m., and Maya was still at her desk, staring at her computer screen. The office was quiet, except for the sound of her typing. Her report was due the next morning, and she still had two sections left to write. She rubbed her eyes and sighed.

Maya had promised herself she would never leave things to the last minute again, but sometimes, things just didn't go as planned. Earlier that week, she had been waiting for important data from the sales department, but it arrived two days late. Then her manager added a few more tasks to her schedule, and now she was paying the price.

Her phone buzzed. It was a message from her coworker Liam: "Still working? Need a hand?" Maya smiled. Liam had already finished his own project, but he often stayed late to help others. "Yes, please!" she replied. Ten minutes later, he appeared with two cups of coffee and his laptop.

"Let's split the work," he said. "You write the summary, and I'll check the numbers." They worked together in silence for a while, and slowly, the report started to take shape.

By 9:30 p.m., it was finally done. Maya leaned back in her chair, exhausted but relieved. "You saved me, Liam," she said. He laughed. "Just buy me lunch tomorrow."

Maya smiled. It wasn't the best evening she'd ever had, but at least she'd met her deadline—and learned that teamwork could make stressful situations a little easier.

Comprehension Questions

1. Why was Maya still at work late at night?

2. What problem delayed her progress earlier in the week?

3. How did Liam help her finish the report?

4. Do you usually finish your tasks early or close to the deadline?

5. How do you feel when you have to work under pressure?
